

Static GK Test -12

Q1. Name the first Odissi classical dancer from Odisha who was conferred the Padma Vibhushan Award.

- A) Kelucharan Mohapatra
- B) Bijayini Satpathy
- C) Sonal Mansingh
- D) Gangadhar Pradhan

Solution: 8.(a) Kelucharan Mohapatra was a legendary Indian classical Odissi dancer. He is the first person to receive the Padma Vibhushan (2000) from Odisha. Other awards - Sangeet Natak Akademi Award (1966), Padma Shri (1974), Padma Bhushan (1988), Sangeet Natak Akademi Fellowship (1991), and Kalidas Samman from Madhya Pradesh government. Bijayini Satpathy (Odissi). Sonal Mansingh (Bharatanatyam and Odissi). She is the youngest recipient of Padma Bhushan in 1992 and Padma Vibhushan in 2003. Gangadhar Pradhan (Odissi).

Q2. Which Indian tabla virtuoso and musician won the 'Best Contemporary World Musi Album' Grammy award for 'Global Drum Project'?

- A) Pandit Sandeep Das
- B) Ustad Alla Rakha
- C) Ustad Zakir Hussain
- D) Pandit Anindo Chatterjee

Solution: 12.(c) Ustad Zakir Hussain (tabla player) won 51st Grammy award on 8 February 2009. Awards and Honors: Padma Shri (1988), Padma Bhushan (2002), Sangeet Natak Akademi Award (1990), Kalidas Samman (2006), Lifetime Achievement Award (2017, San Francisco Jazz Center), Academy Fellow award (2019), Kyoto Prize (2022, Japan's highest private award for global achievement).

Q3. Vishu festival is celebrated in which of the following states?

- A) Kerala And Karnataka
- B) Kerala And Tamil Nadu
- C) Madhya Pradesh & Rajasthan
- D) Gujarat and Maharashtra

Solution: 12.(b) Kerala And Tamil Nadu. Vishu is a Hindu festival celebrated on the first day of the Malayali month of Medam (Malayalam New Year). New year festivals : Ugadi (Andhra Pradesh, Karnataka, Telangana), Gudi Padwa (Maharashtra), Baisakhi (Punjab, Haryana), Pohela Boishakh (West Bengal, Tripura), Puthandu (Tamil Nadu), Bohag Bihu (Assam), Cheti Chand (Sindhi community), Losoong (Sikkim), Navreh (Kashmir), Chaitra Sukladi (North India).

Q4. In which of the following Olympic games did India NOT win Gold?

- A) 1948
- B) 1928
- C) 1932
- D) 1960

Solution: 11.(d) India has won 35 medals at the Olympics since the 1900 edition. Gold medal winners from India: Jaipal Singh (1928 - Amsterdam), Lal Bokhari (1932 - Los Angeles), Dhyan Chand (1936 - Berlin), Kishan Lal (1948 - London), K.D. Singh (1952 - Helsinki), Balbir Singh Sr (1956 - Melbourne), Charanjit Singh (1964 - Tokyo), Vasudevan Bhaskaran (1980 - Moscow), Abhinav Bindra (2008-Beijing), and Neeraj Chopra (2021-Tokyo).

Q5. Sarhul is a famous tribal festival of dance in which state ?

- A) Assam
- B) Sikkim
- C) Jharkhand
- D) Chhattisgarh

Solution: 15.(c) Jharkhand. Sarhul - The festival of the Oraon tribe. It is the festival of the New Year and celebrated in the Hindu month of Chaitra, three days after the appearance of the new moon. It is also a celebration of the beginning of spring. Jharkhand Festivals : Sarhul, Tusu Parab or Makar, Rohini, Bhagta Parab, Chhath Pooja, Bandna.

Q6. Whose birthday is celebrated as International Day of Non-Violence?

- A) Rajendra Prasad
- B) Subhash Chandra Bose
- C) Jawaharlal Nehru
- D) Mahatma Gandhi

Solution: 1.(d) The International Day of Non-Violence is observed on 2 October (birthday of Mahatma Gandhi). 2022 theme: 'Say No to Violence'. Mahatma Gandhi returned to India from South Africa on 9th January 1915. Every year 9th January is celebrated every year as Pravasi Bharatiya Divas (PBD) to mark the contribution of the Overseas Indian community in the development of India. 2022 theme: "Contributing to Atma Nirbhar Bharat".

Q7. What does the letter 'M' stand for in the MRTP Act 1969?

- A) Monopolistic
- B) Monopolies
- C) Multi
- D) Monopoly

Solution: 11.(b) The Monopolies and Restrictive Trade Practices Act (MRTP Act) was enacted in 1969 and came into force from June 1, 1970. This act was replaced by Competition Act 2002 (on the recommendations of Raghavan committee), with effect from September 1, 2009. The Competition Act 2002 was amended by the Competition (Amendment) Act, 2007.

Q8. Sardhana Christian Fair is held in which of the following states?

- A) West Bengal
- B) Haryana
- C) Madhya Pradesh
- D) Uttar Pradesh

Solution: 10.(d) Uttar Pradesh. Sardhana Christian Fair : Every year on the 1st Sunday of the month of November a large feast is held in honor of Mother Mary. Other Fairs of Uttar Pradesh : Kumbh Mela (the festival of the sacred Pitcher), Gau Charan Fair, Nauchandi Fair, Dewa Sharif Fair, Shakumbhari Fair, Magh Fair (Prayagraj), Rath Fair (Vrindavan), Agra Cattle Fair or Bateshwar Fair (Agra).

Q9. Arjuna awardee Dr Ajmer Singh is associated with which game?

- A) Football
- B) Table Tennis
- C) Athletics
- D) Badminton

Solution: 10.(c) Athletics. Arjun Award - It is the second-highest sporting honor. First awarded - 1961. Ajmer Singh was an Indian sprinter who competed in the 1964 Summer Olympics, was a gold medalist at the 1966 Asian Games, in Bangkok. Award - Arjun award (1966).

Q10. Which event was hosted at Lord's Cricket Ground(LCG) at the 2012 Olympics ?

- A) Boxing
- B) Cricket
- C) Archery
- D) Equestrian

Solution: 1.(c) Archery. First archery national championship held in Grenoble, France in July 1973. Cricket grounds used in Olympics: Melbourne Cricket Ground {1956 (Indian Hockey Team win 6th gold), 2000}, The Gaba, Sydney (2000). Archery players - Deepika Kumari, Atanu Das, Jayanta Talukdar, Dola Banerjee. Archery Association of India - Formed in 1973, Headquarter - New delhi.

Q11. Garba dance is a popular dance of which state?

- A) Bihar
- B) Gujarat
- C) Goa
- D) Assam

Solution: 5.(b) Gujarat. Garba is a popular Gujarat folk dance performed during Navratri. Important Folk Dances: Gujarat - Dandiya Raas, Tippani

Juriun. Assam - Bihu, Bichhua, Natpuja, Maharas, Khel Gopal, Tabal Chongli. Bihar - Jata-Jatin, Bakho-Bakhain, Panwariya, Bidesia. Goa - Tarangamel, Dekhni, Fugdi, Shigmo, Ghode Modni, Samayi nrutya, Ranmale.

Q12. Ali Akbar Khan was associated with which of the following gharanas?

- A) **Maihar gharana**
- B) Agra gharana
- C) Gwalior gharana
- D) Kirana gharana

Solution: 11.(a) Maihar gharana. Ali Akbar Khan : Awards - Padma Bhushan (1967), Padma Vibhushan (1989). Exponents of Maihar gharana : Allauddin Khan, Pandit Nikhil Ranjan Banerjee, Nityanand Haldipur. Agra gharana : Founders - Haji Sujan Khan; Ustad Gagghe Khuda Bakhsh. Gwalior Gharana : Founders - Ustad Hassu Khan, Ustad Haddu Khan and Ustad Nathu Khan. Kirana Gharana : Founders - Abdul Karim Khan and Abdul Wahid Khan.

Q13. Which of the following dance forms is associated with the state of Arunachal Pradesh?

- A) Panwariya
- B) Dhaman
- C) **Buiya**
- D) Garba

Solution: 15.(c) Buiya is a folk dance of Arunachal Pradesh performed by the Digaru Mishmi tribe. This dance is performed in multiple festivals like Tazampu, Duiya, and Tanuya. Other dances of Arunachal Pradesh include Chalo dance (Nocte tribe), Oriah Dance (Wancho tribe), Pasi Kongki (Adi Tribe), Ponung Dance (Adi Tribe), Popir Dance (Galo tribe), Bardo Chham (Sherdukpen community), etc. Panwariya dance (Bihar), Dhaman dance (Himachal Pradesh), and Garba (Gujarat).

Q14. Which of the following options best describes the purpose of Pradhan Mantri Shram Yogi Mann-Dhan (PM-SYM) scheme, 2019 ?

- A) Provide healthcare services to pregnant women
- B) Provide education loans to financially weak students
- C) **Provide pension to unorganized sector workers**
- D) Provide financial assistance to small and marginal farmers

Solution: 6.(c). Pradhan Mantri Shram Yogi Maan Dhan (PM-SYM) scheme - The scheme provides a monthly pension of Rs. 3000/- to subscribers after they attain the age of 60 years. The scheme is for the age group of 18-40 years.

Q15. When is Raksha Bandhan celebrated in India as per the Hindu calendar?

- A) Amavasya, Shravan month
- B) Poornima, Ashadha month
- C) Amavasya, Ashadha month
- D) **Poornima, Shravan month**

Solution: 6.(d) Raksha Bandhan is a festival that is celebrated on the full moon day in the month of Shravan (July 23 - August 22) according to the Hindu Lunar calendar. Other months of Hindu calendar: Chaitra (March – April), Vaishakha (April - May), Jyeshtha (May - June), Ashadha (June - July), Bhadra (August - September), Ashwin (September - October), Kartika (October - November), Agrahayana (November - December), Pausa(December - January), Magha (January - February), and Phalguna (February - March).

Q16. Who was recognised as ‘Asthana Nartaki’ (resident dancer) of the Tirumala Tirupati Devasthanam for her contribution in the development and promotion of the Indian classical dance forms?

- A) Rukmini Devi
- B) Ragini Devi
- C) **Yamini Krishnamurthy**
- D) Uma Sharma

Solution: 13.(c) Mungara Yamini Krishnamurthy (Bharatanatyam and Kuchipudi dancer). She was also known as the "torch bearer" of Kuchipudi form of dance. Her autobiography: ‘A passion for dance’. Awards and

Honors: Padma Shri (1968), Padma Bhushan (2001), Padma Vibhushan (2016), "Natya Shastra" (2014, by Shambhavi School of Dance), etc. Rukmini Devi Arundale (Bharatnatyam dancer), Ragini Devi (Bharata Natyam, Kuchipudi, Kathakali and Odissi dancer), Uma Sharma (Kathak dancer).

Q17. Ugadi is celebrated in which of the following states?

- A) Madhya Pradesh
- B) **Andhra Pradesh**
- C) Himachal Pradesh
- D) Kerala

Solution: 13.(b) Ugadi or Yugadi (Samvatsarādi - Beginning of the Year) - Andhra Pradesh, Telangana, and Karnataka. Other traditional new year in India - Chaitra Shukladi, Gudi Padwa (Maharashtra), Cheti Chand (Sindhi New Year), Vaisakhi (Punjab, Haryana), Vishu (Kerala, Karnataka), Naba Barsha (West Bengal), Vaisakhadi and Puthandu-Pirappu (Tamil) and Bohag Bihu (Assam).

Q18. Which of the following presents awards and recognitions in the field of Indian dances?

- A) INTACH
- B) **Sangeet Natak Akademi**
- C) Sahitya Akademi
- D) Lalit Kala Akademi

Solution: 2.(b) Sangeet Natak Akademi: The apex body in the field of performing arts in the country, was set up in 1953. The Chairman of the Akademi is appointed by the President of India for a term of five years. Sahitya Akademi (1954) - Headquarter - Rabindra Bhawan, Delhi. Lalit Kala Akademi (1954) - Headquarters - Rabindra Bhavan, Delhi. INTACH (Indian National Trust for Art and Cultural Heritage) (1984) - Headquarter - New Delhi.

Q19. Which of the following folk dances is primarily performed in the Indian state of Bihar?

- A) Ghoomar
- B) Kalbeliya
- C) **Bidesia**
- D) Kummatti

Solution: 10.(c) Bidesia (Bihar) - based on a drama named Bidesiya written by Bhikhari Thakur. Other folk dances of Bihar - Jata-Jatin, Bakho-Bakhain, Panwariya. Kalbeliya (Rajasthan) - Performed by Kalbelia tribe (snake charming tribe from the Thar Desert). Ghoomar (Rajasthan) - Performed by Bhil tribe to worship Goddess Sarasvati. Kummatti Kali (Kerala) - colorful mask-dance performed during Onam festival.

Q20. Who among the following was the guru of Pandit Ravi Shankar ?

- A) Bismillah Khan
- B) Amjad Ali Khan
- C) Ali Akbar Khan
- D) **Allauddin Khan**

Solution: 1.(d) Allauddin Khan (Sarod player) was the guru of Pandit Ravi Shankar. He was the court musician for the Maharaja of Maihar. He was the founder of modern Maihar gharana. He was awarded the Padma Bhushan (1958) and the Padma Vibhushan (1971), Sangeet Natak Akademi award and Sangeet Natak Akademi Fellowship (1954). Bismillah Khan (Shehnai player); Amjad Ali Khan (Sarod player); Ali Akbar Khan (Sarod player; Maihar Gharana).

Q21. In India census is held regularly every _____ year.

- A) 8th
- B) **10th**
- C) 12th
- D) 5th

Solution: 14.(b) Indian Census is conducted after every 10 years by the Office of the Registrar General and Census Commissioner, Ministry of Home Affairs. The first census of India was conducted in 1881. Under Article 246, The population census is a Union subject (listed 69) of the seventh schedule of the constitution. The first complete census of an Indian city was conducted

in 1830 by Henry Walter (father of Indian Census) in Dacca (now Dhaka).

Q22. Who among the following has won Oscars as well as a Golden Globe award for his contribution to international music?

- A) Pt. Jasraj
- B) A.R.Rahman**
- C) Ravi Shankar
- D) Zakir Hussain

Solution: 3.(b) A.R. Rahman is a winner of six National Film Awards (1992, 1996, 2001, 2002, 2017 (2 times)), two Oscar Awards (2009 and 2011), Padma Shri (2000), Padma Bhushan (2010) two Grammy Awards (both in 2009), a BAFTA Award (2009), a Golden Globe Award (2009), fifteen Filmfare Awards and seventeen Filmfare Awards South.

Q23. Asiad is regulated by _____.

- A) International Olympic Council
- B) Commonwealth Games Federation
- C) Indian Olympic Council
- D) Olympic Council of Asia**

Solution: 14.(d) Asiad (Asian Games) - held every four years. First held in 1951 in New Delhi. Regulated by Asian Games Federation (AGF) till 1978. But now, from 1982, organized by the Olympic Council of Asia (OCA). Indian Olympic Association - governing body for the Olympic Movement and the Commonwealth Games in India. Commonwealth Games Federation - international organization responsible for the direction and control of the Commonwealth Games. International Olympic Council - responsible for Olympic games.

Q24. Rukmani Devi Arundale was a famous dancer of which Indian classical dance form?

- A) Bharatanatyam**
- B) Kathak
- C) Mohiniyattam
- D) Kathakali

Solution: 7.(a) Rukmani Devi Arundale (Tamil Nadu) is a famous dancer of Bharatanatyam classical dance form. Awards and honors: Padma Bhushan (1956), Sangeet Natak Award (1957), Sangeet Natak Akademi Fellowship (1967). Bharatanatyam Dancers: Mallika Sarabhai, Yamini Krishnamurthy, Alamel Valli, Padma Subrahmanyam etc.

Q25. Decadal growth rate of population between 2001 - 2011 is _____.

- A) 18.70 percent
- B) 15.70 percent
- C) 17.70 percent**
- D) 16.70 percent

Solution: 7.(c) According to the first results of Census 2011, India's population growth rate has decelerated to 17.64 per cent in the decade 2001-11. 2011 Census: State with the highest population density (Bihar), State with the lowest population density (Arunachal Pradesh), Union territory with least population (Lakshadweep), State with the highest population (Uttar Pradesh), State with the lowest population (Sikkim).

Q26. Who among the following was the first Indian to win the Grammy Award?

- A) Pandit Ravi Shankar**
- B) Pandit Shiv Kumar Sharma
- C) Pandit Vishwa Mohan Bhatt
- D) Ustad Zakir Hussain

Solution: 6.(a) Ravi Shankar (sitarist). He was the first Indian to win a Grammy for 'West Meets East', the 1968 album with American violinist Yehudi Menuhin. He has won five grammy awards. Awards :- Bharat Ratna (1999), Padma Vibhushan (1981), Padma Bhushan (1967), Sangeet Natak Akademi Award (1962), Sangeet Natak Akademi Fellowship (1975), Kalidas Samman (1987-88). Pandit Shivkumar Sharma (santoor). Vishwa Mohan Bhatt (Mohan veena). Ustad Zakir Hussain (tabla player).

Q27. Bhakti Pradeep Kulkarni is associated with ____.

- A) badminton

- B) kabaddi
- C) chess**
- D) cricket

Solution: 14.(c) chess. Bhakti Kulkarni received the FIDE titles of Woman Grandmaster (WGM) in 2012 and International Master (IM) in 2019. Other Chess Players : Subbaraman Vijayalakshmi, Pentala Harikrishna, Divya Deshmukh, Koneru Humpy, Rameshbabu Praggnanandhaa, Viswanathan Anand, Dibyendu Barua.

Q28. Which of the following folk dances does NOT belong to the state of Madhya Pradesh ?

- A) Laho**
- B) Phulpati
- C) Matki
- D) Jawara

Solution: 8.(a) Laho dance is a part of Behdienkhlam festival, performed by the Jaintia tribe of Meghalaya. Some other famous dances of Meghalaya include Nongkrem Dance, Shad Suk Mynsiem, Wangala Dance, Dorsegata Dance, etc. Folk dances of Madhya Pradesh include Jawara, Matki, Aada, Khada Nach, Phulpati, Grida Dance, Selalarki, Selabhadoni, Maanch, etc.

Q29. In AIBA Boxing Junior Boys and Girls Competitions, the bouts must consist of each round of _____minutes.

- A) 5 min
- B) 3 min
- C) 1 min
- D) 2 min**

Solution: 2.(d) In all AOB Junior Boys' and Girls' Competitions, the Bouts (boxing match) must consist of three rounds of two minutes each. A standard ring is between 16 and 24 feet (4.9 and 7.3 m) to a side between the ropes with another 2 feet (0.61 m) outside.

Q30. Which of the following Odissi dancers was honored with the Padma Vibhushan in 2000?

- A) Kelucharan Mohapatra**
- B) Madhavi Mudgal
- C) Sanjukta Panigrahi
- D) Priyambada Mohanty Hejmadi

Solution: 9.(a) Kelucharan Mohapatra: Awards - Padma Vibhushan (2000), Padma Bhushan (1988), Padma Shri (1974), Sangeet Natak Akademi Award (1966), Sangeet Natak Akademi Fellowship (1991). Other Odissi Dancers - Madhumita Raut, Saswat Joshi, Ratikant Mohapatra, Sanjukta Panigrahi etc.

Q31. The headquarters of the National Institute of Oceanography of India is located at:

- A) New Delhi
- B) Hyderabad
- C) Kanyakumari
- D) Goa**

Solution: 15.(d) National Institute of Oceanography (NIO) of India - headquartered at Dona Paula, Goa. regional offices in Kochi, Mumbai, and Vizag. It is one of the 38 constituent laboratories of the Council of Scientific & Industrial Research (CSIR), New Delhi. NIO was founded on 1 January 1966.

Q32. In which year was Kalidas Samman established?

- A) 1978
- B) 1975
- C) 1984
- D) 1980**

Solution: 2.(d) The Kalidas Samman was first awarded in 1980. It is an arts award presented annually by the government of Madhya Pradesh in India. 1980-81 (Semangudi Srinivasa Iyer and Mallikarjun Mansur). 2022 {Pandit Venkatesh Kumar (Hindustani vocalist and belong to Kirana and Gwalior Gharana).

Q33. Elelakkaradi dance of Kerala is performed by which of the following tribes?

- A) Irular tribe**
 B) Kurumba tribe
 C) Adiyar tribe
 D) Mavilar tribe

Solution: 13.(a) Irular tribe. Elelakkaradi : The dance resembles the fight of the people against the wild bears which often attack their tribal hamlets. Other dances of Kerala : Mudi yettu dance, Thiruvathirakali, Kolkali, Oppana, Kummattikali, Chavittu Natakam, Kakkariissi Natakam, Kanyarkali, Arjuna Nritham, Ezhamathukali, Alamikali, Vedanpaattu, Onathar.

Q34. Wangala festival is celebrated by which of the following tribes?

- A) Bhil tribe
B) Garo tribe
 C) Tharu tribe
 D) Bhutia tribe

Solution: 7.(b) Wangala Festival (100 drums festival) - Garos of Meghalaya. Wangala Festival is a harvest festival held in honor of Saljong, the Sun-god of fertility. It also signifies the onset of winter. Bhil tribe - Bhagoria Festivals (Madhya Pradesh). Tharu tribe (southern Nepal and northern India) - Dashain (Vijayadashami), Tihar (Deepawali), and Jitiya. Bhutia tribe (Sikkim) - Losar festival.

Q35. How much purse money was given to a Sangeet Natak Akademi fellow in 2019?

- A) ₹4 lakh
B) ₹3 lakh
 C) ₹2 lakh
 D) ₹1 lakh

Solution: 9.(b) Sangeet Natak Akademi Fellowship: Awarded for the performing arts in India, Sponsored by (Sangeet Natak Academy), Reward(s) (₹3 lakh), First awarded (1954: Allauddin Khan, Hafiz Ali Khan, Ariyakudi Ramanuja Iyengar, Karaikudi Sambasiva Iyer, and Prithviraj Kapoor).

Q36. With which of the following Indian states is the folk dance Lezim associated?

- A) Maharashtra**
 B) Kerala
 C) Arunachal Pradesh
 D) Jharkhand

Solution: 15.(a) Folk dances of Maharashtra: Lezim, Lavani, Nakata, Koli, Gafa, Dahikala Dasavtar or Bohada, Tamasha, Mauni, Powara, Gouricha, etc. Kerala: Ottam Thullal, Kaikottikali, Tappatikali, Kali Auttam, etc. Arunachal Pradesh: Chham, Mask dance (Mukhauta Nritya), War dance, Buiya, Chalo, Wancho, Pasi Kongki, Ponung, Popir, Bardo, etc. Jharkhand: Karma, Agni, Jhumar, Janani Jhumar, Mardana Jhumar, Paika, Phagua, Chhanu, Sarahul, Jat-Jatin, Karma, Danga, Bidesia, Sohrai, Hunta Dance, Mundari Dance, Sarhul, Barao, Jhitka, Danga, Domkach, Ghora Naach, etc.

Q37. Manimekalai describes the story of which of the following?

- A) Kovalan and Madhavi's Daughter**
 B) Kovalan's wife Madhavi
 C) Kovalan's first wife Kannagi
 D) Kovalan and Madhavi's Son

Solution: 14.(a) Manimekalai describes the story of the daughter of Kovalan and Madhavi. It is a Tamil-Buddhist epic written by Kulavanikan Seethalai Sataar in the 6th century. Other Great Epics of Tamil Literature are Cilappatikaram (written by Ilango Adigal, story of Kannaki and Kovalan), Civaka Cintamani (written by Tirutakkatevar, story of King Caccantan), Kundalakesi (composed by Nagasena, story of Kundalakesi and Kalan), and Valayapathi (story of a father who has two wives).

Q38. Which of the following pairs of musicians and their instruments is INCORRECT?

- A) K Vaidyanathan - Sitar**
 B) Pt. Ram Narayan - Sarangi
 C) Ustad Vilayat Khan - Sitar
 D) Bismillah Khan - Shehnai

Solution: 13.(a) Kunnakudi Vaidyanathan was an Indian classical music

violinist and music composer. Awards and Honours: Padma Shri (1993), Kalaimamani award (1993), Sangeet Natak Akademi Award (1993), Sangeetha Kalasikhamani award (1996), Tamil Nadu State Film Award for Best Music Director (1970), and Tamil Nadu State Film Honorary Award - Raja Sando Award (2000).

Q39. The 'Glide Technique' is used in which track and field event ?

- A) Pole Vault
 B) 4 x 100 m Relay
C) Shot Put
 D) Long Jump

Solution: 13.(c) Shot Put. Sports Terminology : Wrestling - Freestyle, Bridge out, Breakdown, Pin. Weight Lifting - Snatch, Jerk. Volleyball - Spike, Wipe, Pancake. Tennis - Deuce, Angle-game, Alley, Stance, Lob. Shooting - Bore, Bull, Bunker, Offhand. Swimming - Butterfly, Breaststroke, Backstroke, Front Crawl.

Q40. Jata-Jatin is the folk dance of which Indian state?

- A) Manipur
 B) Odisha
C) Bihar
 D) West Bengal

Solution: 5.(c) Jat-Jatin is famous among the northern parts of Bihar, especially Mithila. Dances of Bihar: Karma Dance, Jhijhiya Dance, Kajri Dance, Jhumar Dance, Bhojpuri Jhumar Dance, Magahi Jhumar Dance, Jharni Dance, etc.

Q41. Who among the following was the youngest recipient of the Sangeetha Kalanidhi awarded by the Music Academy in 1947?

- A) Semmangudi Radhakrishna Srinivasa Iyer**
 B) Ariyakudi Ramanuja Iyengar
 C) Mallikarjun Bheemarayappa Mansur
 D) Bhimsen Joshi

Solution: 7.(a) Semmangudi Radhakrishna Srinivasa Iyer (Vocalist) : Awards - National Eminence Award (2002), Kalidas Samman (1980). Ariyakudi Ramanuja Iyengar : Awards - Sangeetha Kalanidhi award (1938), Padma Bhushan (1958). Mallikarjun Bheemarayappa Mansur : Awards - Padma Shri (1970), Padma Bhushan (1976), Padma Vibhushan (1992). Bhimsen Joshi : Awards - Padma Shri (1972), Padma Bhushan (1985), Padma Vibhushan (1999), Bharat Ratna (2009).

Q42. Which web portal was launched by the Department of Telecommunications for sharing information on mobile towers and EMF emission compliance?

- A) E-Amrit
 B) Namaste
C) Tarang Sanchar
 D) PM-Daksh

Solution: 8.(c) Tarang Sanchar. It has been developed in Public Private Partnership (PPP) mode by the Department of Telecommunications with Industry. Through the portal, the public can access the following services : Locate mobile towers in vicinity of any locality, Locate mobile towers with their EMF Safety Status based on your current location, EMF Measurement Request by Public, Learning resources on EMF.

Q43. Gandharva Mahavidyalaya, which was founded by Pandit Vinaya Chandra Maudgalya, is located at ____.

- A) New Delhi**
 B) Pune
 C) Kolkata
 D) Mumbai

Solution: 2.(a) New Delhi. Gandharva Mahavidyalaya was established in 1939. It is one of the oldest and most distinguished cultural institutions of Delhi. Its role in imparting training to entire generations of music lovers and bringing Indian classical music and dance into the cultural mainstream is well acknowledged.

Q44. In chess, which of the following may only move forward to the

unoccupied square immediately in front of it?

- A) The Bishop
- B) The Queen
- C) The Pawn**
- D) The Rook

Solution: 3.(c) The Pawn. Chess is a board game for two players. It is played on a square board, made up of 64 smaller squares, with eight squares in each row and column. Chess Pieces Move: King - Moves one square in any direction. Queen - Moves any number of squares diagonally, horizontally, or vertically. Rook - Moves any number of squares horizontally or vertically. Bishop - Moves any number of squares diagonally. Knight - Moves in an 'L-shape,' two squares in a straight direction, and then one square perpendicular to that.

Q45. The length of a Beach Volleyball court is:

- A) 12 m
- B) 16 m**
- C) 20 m
- D) 15 m

Solution: 9.(b) Beach volleyball - Court is 16 m long & 8 m wide. Two teams of two or more players. An Olympic sport since the 1996 Summer Olympics (Atlanta). Volleyball - court is 18m long and 9m wide. Two teams of six players. An Olympic sport since the 1964 Summer Olympics (Tokyo). Federation Internationale de Volleyball (FIVB) is the international governing body for both of the games.

Q46. The abbreviation "CPCL" is associated with the petroleum industry in India. Expand "CPCL":

- A) Central Petroleum Corporation Limited
- B) Coimbatore Petroleum Corporation Limited
- C) Chennai Petroleum Corporation Limited**
- D) Corporation of Petroleum and Chemicals Limited

Solution: 10.(c) Chennai Petroleum Corporation Limited (CPCL) is a subsidiary of Indian Oil Corporation which is under the ownership of the Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas of the Government of India. Headquarters: Chennai, Founded: 18 November 1965, Chairman: Shrikant Madhav Vaidya, Managing Director: Arvind Kumar (As of December 2022).

Q47. Which of the following is one of the objectives of 'Swadesh Darshan 2.0 Scheme'?

- A) To provide vocational training to youth
- B) To enhance the contribution of farming
- C) To increase private sector investment in tourism and hospitality**
- D) To promote local art and culture, handicrafts and cuisines etc.

Solution: 12.(c). Swadesh Darshan 2.0 Scheme: A central sector scheme launched by the Ministry of Tourism and Culture, Government of India. The scheme focuses on the integrated development of theme-based tourist circuits in India. Aim - To promote, develop, and harness the potential of the tourism sector in India. Launched - 2014 - 15. Objective - It envisages an increase in private sector investment in tourism & hospitality.

Q48. In which of the following states was 'Kudumbashree,' women-oriented, community-- based, poverty-reduction programme implemented?

- A) Maharashtra
- B) Kerala**
- C) Bihar
- D) Uttar Pradesh

Solution: 10.(b) Kudumbashree is the poverty eradication and women empowerment programme implemented by the State Poverty Eradication Mission (SPEM) of the Government of Kerala. The name Kudumbashree in Malayalam language means 'prosperity of the family'. The 'Kudumbashree' SHG (Self Help Groups) was started in 1998.

Q49. The height of stumps in cricket is _____

- A) 28 inches**
- B) 20 inches
- C) 25 inches
- D) 22 inches

Solution: 6.(a) Height of stumps in cricket 28 inches. Cricket pitch breadth : 10 feet. Important terminologies used in Cricket: Striker, Off-side/leg-side, Run, Four, Bowled, Caught, LBW, Stumped, Innings, etc.

Q50. Tevitchiyattam, Nangai Natakam and Dasiyattam are the forms of which of the following classical dances?

- A) Odissi dance
- B) Kathakali dance
- C) Sattriya dance
- D) Mohiniyattam dance**

Solution: 4.(d) Mohiniyattam dance (Classical dance form of Kerala in South India). Famous Dancer - Smitha Rajan, Sunanda Nair, Gopika Varma, Kanak Rele. Famous classical dance and their components : Kathakali -Kathi, Pacha,Thadi, Minukku, Vesham. Sattriya dance - Nritya, Nritya, Natya. Odissi dance - Mangalacharan, Sthayee or Batu, Pallavi, Abhinaya, Mokshya.

Q51. Simhastha fair is held in Ujjain on the bank of which river?

- A) Kshipra river**
- B) Son river
- C) Ganga river
- D) Gandak river

Solution: 7.(a) Kshipra river. Ujjain Simhastha is a Hindu religious mela held every 12 years in the Ujjain city of Madhya Pradesh. Other Fairs in India: Kumbh Mela is the largest religious gathering in the world and is held every 3 years (It is celebrated four times every 12 years) in four places : Haridwar, Nashik, Ujjain, and Prayagraj. Sonepur Cattle Fair: Ganges and Gandak rivers (Bihar). Largest cattle fair in Asia. Pushkar Fair - Pushkar Lake (Rajasthan). Hemis Fair - Indus river.

Q52. Which of the following folk dance forms is NOT associated with the state of Gujarat?

- A) Hojagiri**
- B) Dandiya
- C) Bhavai
- D) Garba

Solution: 4.(a) Dance Forms of Gujarat: Dandiya, Garba, Bhavai, Tippi, Padhar, Hoodo. Tripura: Hojagiri , Gorla, Lebang Boomani, Hai-hak, jhum, Sangrai.

Q53. For which year was Manna Dey honored with the Dadasaheb Phalke Award?

- A) 2015
- B) 2019
- C) 2007**
- D) 2001

Solution: 12.(c) Manna Dey (singer) - Dadasaheb Phalke Award in 2007. Belonged to the Bhendi Bazaar Gharana and was trained under Ustad Aman Ali Khan. Dadasaheb Phalke Award - India's highest award in the field of cinema. Presented annually at the National Film Awards ceremony by the Directorate of Film Festivals, Ministry of Information and Broadcasting. First awarded in 1969. Asha Parekh received the award in 2022 for her Outstanding Contribution To Film Industry.

Q54. Shovana Narayan was awarded which of the following awards in 2013?

- A) Guru Deba Prasad**
- B) Sangam Kala
- C) Kalidas Samman
- D) Bharat Muni Samman

Solution: 9.(a) Shovana Narayan was awarded Guru Deba Prasad in 2013. Awards and Honors: Padma Shri (1992), Sangeet Natak Akademi Award (1999–2000), Oisca Award (Japan) (1990–91), Dadabhai Naoroji Award (1993), Bihar Gaurav Puraskar (1985), Guru ML Koser Award (2013), Art Karat Award (2014), Bharat Nirman's Social Responsibility Award 2014 etc.

Q55. The National Youth Policy was launched in:

- A) 2012
- B) 2013

C) 2014

D) 2015

Solution: 15.(c) 2014. The National Youth Policy (NYP) defines "youth" as individuals aged 15 to 29 years and aims to enhance their growth opportunities. It focuses on improving access to social infrastructure, education, and employment, empowering young people to overcome societal challenges.

Q56. The Asian Games 2018 were held in which of the following countries?

A) South Korea

B) Indonesia

C) Japan

D) China

Solution: 5.(b) Asian Games 2018: Host {Jakarta and Palembang (Indonesia)}; Top Ranked Team (China). 2022: Host {Hangzhou (China); will be held from 23 September to 8 October 2023}; 2026: Host {Aichi-Nagoya (Japan)}; 2030: Host {Doha (Qatar)}; 2034: Host {Riyadh (Saudi Arabia)}.

Q57. Which is the joint digital skills initiative for employability through digital skills by National Career Service and Microsoft India?

A) Digisaksham

B) Vidyadaan

C) Shiksha Vani

D) Swyam

Solution: 4.(a) Digisaksham. The DigiSaksham program was launched in 2021. The program was a collaboration between the Ministry of Labour and Employment (MoLE) and Microsoft India. Goal : To help job seekers become more employable by teaching them digital skills. Other Initiatives for Youth Employment : Pradhan Mantri Mudra Yojana (PMMY), National Career Service, and Pradhan Mantri Kaushal Vikas Yojana 3.0.

Q58. Who among the following is a famous performer of the Kathakali classical dance?

A) Pankaj Charan Das

B) Sunanda Nayar

C) Gopinath

D) Raja Reddy

Solution: 8.(c) Guru Gopinath was a well known Kathakali dancer. Awards and Honors: Sangeet Natak Akademi's award (1965), 'Kala Tilakam' by the Guruvayur Devaswom (1968), 'Kala RatIn' title by the Travancore Devaswom Board (1973), etc. Pankaj Charan Das (Odissi dancer), Sunanda Nair (Mohiniattam dancer), Raja Reddy (Kuchipudi dancer).

Q59. Which of the following countries hosted the first edition of the Summer Youth Olympic Games in 2010?

A) China

B) Singapore

C) Argentina

D) Senegal

Solution: 5.(b) The first summer edition was held in Singapore from 14 to 26 August 2010. Winner: China. 2nd edition 2014 {Nanjing (China), Winner: China}, 3rd edition 2018 {Buenos Aires (Argentina), Winner: Russia}.

Q60. Talat Aziz is primarily a _____ singer.

A) Hindustani Classical

B) Carnatic Classical

C) Ghazal

D) Folk

Solution: 3.(c) Ghazal. Musical genres and singers: Ghazal - Jagjit Singh (King of Ghazals), Hariharan, Pankaj Udhas, Bhupinder Singh; Hindustani Classical - Ananda Shankar, Tansen. Carnatic Classical - M. S. Subbulakshmi, Aruna Sairam, M. Balamuralikrishna .Folk - Swaroop Khan, Sharda Sinha, Kailash Kher.

Q61. Which of the following states have the highest literacy rate, according to census 2011?

A) Lakshadweep

B) Goa

C) Mizoram

D) Kerala

Solution: 4.(d) According to Census 2011: Top Literate States: Kerala (94.00 %) followed by Lakshadweep, Mizoram, Goa, and Tripura. Most Populated Metros: Mumbai followed by Delhi, Kolkata, Chennai, and Bangalore.

Q62. In which season is Sarhul celebrated in Jharkhand?

A) Spring

B) Autumn

C) Monsoon

D) Winter

Solution: 12.(a) Sarhul is a spring festival celebrated for three days, from the 3rd day of Chaitra month (March - April) in Sukla Paksh to Chaitra Purnima in the Indian state of Jharkhand. It is an important festival observed by the ethnic groups, Kurukh and Sadan. Other festivals celebrated in Jharkhand are Karam, Jawa, Makar or Tusu Parab, Hal Punhya, Bhagta Parab, Rohini, Bandna, etc.

Q63. The Mohiniyattam dance form originated from which state?

A) Kerala

B) Karnataka

C) Tamil Nadu

D) Maharashtra

Solution: 11.(a) Mohiniyattam - originated from Kerala. Mohini – a famous female avatar of the Hindu god Vishnu in Indian mythology. Total 8 classical dance forms - Bharatnatyam (Tamil Nadu), Kathak (North India), Kathakali (Kerala), Kuchipudi (Andhra Pradesh), Mohiniyattam (Kerala), Odissi (Odisha), Sattriya (Assam), Manipuri (Manipur).

Q64. In which year did Nitu Ghanghas win India's first gold medal at the World Boxing Championships?

A) 2022

B) 2021

C) 2020

D) 2023

Solution: 14.(d) 2023 (Held in New Delhi, India). Nitu Ghanghas - An Indian boxer (48 kg). Her achievements : Gold medal winner (73rd Strandja Memorial Boxing Tournament) held in Sofia, Bulgaria in 2022. Commonwealth Games 2022 (Birmingham) - Gold medal in Minimum weight. IBA Women's World Boxing Championships 2024 : Astana, Kazakhstan.

Q65. Indian council of Historical Research, an autonomous organization, was set up by the Government of India in _____.

A) 1991

B) 1982

C) 1972

D) 1962

Solution: 8.(c) 1972. Indian Council of Historical Research (ICHR) - It is a captive body of the Ministry of Education, Government of India established by an administrative order. Aim - To promote and give directions to historical research and to encourage and foster objective and scientific writing of history. Headquarters - New Delhi. Regional centers - Pune (Maharashtra), Bengaluru (Karnataka), and Guwahati (Assam). Founded : 27 March 1972. First chairman - Ram Sharan Sharma.

Q66. In which of the following states is Me-dam-me-phi festival primarily celebrated?

A) Bihar

B) Assam

C) Nagaland

D) Odisha

Solution: 5.(b) Assam. Me-Dam-Me-Phi is a community festival celebrated by the Ahom people in memory of their dearly departed. 'Me' means offering, 'Dam' means ancestors and 'Phi' means god. The major festivals celebrated in Assam are Bihu, Baishagu, Ali-Ai-Ligang, Baikho, Rongker,

Bohaggiyo Bishu, and Ambubashi Mela.

Q67. India hosted the Asian Games in which of the following years?

- A) 1954 and 1986
- B) 1951 and 1982**
- C) 1951 and 1986
- D) 1954 and 1982

Solution: 9.(b) 1951 and 1982. The Asian Games are organized by the Olympic Council of Asia (OCA) every four years, with headquarters in Kuwait. The 20th Asian Games will be held in Nagoya, Japan, in 2026. Kamaljeet Sandhu became the first Indian woman to win an individual gold medal at the 1970 Asian Games. Bangkok, Thailand, has hosted the most Asian Games (1966, 1970, 1978, and 1998), followed by South Korea in 1986, 2002, and 2014.

Q68. Who among the following personalities is an award winning Bhojpuri folk singer?

- A) Ila Arun
- B) Rabbi Shergill
- C) Malini Awasthi**
- D) Papon

Solution: 11.(c) Malini Awasthi - An Indian folk singer who sings in Bhojpuri, Awadhi/Audhi, and Hindi languages. Award - Padma Shri (2016). Ila Arun is an Indian film actress, music composer and singer. Rabbi Shergill is a Punjabi folk singer. Papon is an Assamese folk singer.

Q69. Vempati Chinna Satyam was awarded the Padma Bhushan in 1998. He was a _____ dancer.

- A) Kuchipudi**
- B) Kathak
- C) Manipuri
- D) Kathakali

Solution: 3.(a) Vempati Chinna Satyam (Andhra Pradesh) is a great dancer and master of Kuchipudi dance. He started the Kuchipudi Kala Academy in 1963 in Madras. Awards and honors: Kalidas Award by the Government of Madhya Pradesh and Kalaimamani by the Government of Tamil Nadu. He was awarded the doctorate degree by Andhra University. Other famous proponents of Kuchipudi Dance include- Raja and Radha Reddy, their daughter Yamini Reddy; Kaushalya Reddy; Bhavana Reddy, etc. Indrani Bajpai (Indrani Rahman) is a famous exponent of Kuchipudi Dance.

Q70. Who among the following choreographers from Bollywood was a three time National Award winner in 2003, 2007 and 2009 ? He/She worked in many Hindi movies including Sanjay Leela Bhansali's movie 'Devdas'?

- A) Geeta Kapoor
- B) Saroj Khan**
- C) Farah Khan
- D) Vaibhavi Marchant

Solution: 4.(b) Saroj Khan won three National Awards in 2003, 2007, and 2009 for the films Devdas, Sringaram, and Jab we met respectively. She was an Indian dance choreographer in Hindi cinema and was best known for the dance form mujra. She won Filmfare Best Choreography Award 8 times (1989 (first recipient of this award), 1990, 1991, 1993, 1994, 2000, 2003, and 2008).

Q71. By which name is the birthday of Lord Krishna famous?

- A) Mahashtami
- B) Maha Navami
- C) Janmashtami**
- D) Akshaya Tritiya

Solution: 2.(c) Janmashtami (August-September), also known as Gokulashtami, is an annual Hindu festival celebrated to celebrate the birth of Lord Krishna, the eighth of Vishnu's Dashavatara and the twenty-second of the twenty-four incarnations. It is celebrated in Bhadrapada on the eighth day (Ashtami) of Krishna Paksha (dark fortnight), according to the Hindu lunisolar calendar.

Q72. Who has become the first woman director general of the Council of Scientific and Industrial Research?

- A) Sanjay Verma
- B) Vinod Aggarwal
- C) Nallathamby Kalaiselvi**
- D) Prakash Chand

Solution: 1.(c) Nallathamby Kalaiselvi became the first women director general of the Council of Scientific and Industrial Research (CSIR). CSIR: Founded: 26 september 1942, Headquarters: New Delhi. Prakash Chand {Ambassador: Eritrea}. Vinod Aggarwal: {President of SIAM (Society of Indian Automobile Manufacturers)}.

Q73. The 'Rann Utsav' is organized in which of the following states of India to promote tourism?

- A) Gujarat**
- B) Rajasthan
- C) Punjab
- D) Maharashtra

Solution: 3.(a) Rann Utsav is celebrated every year from November till Holi in the Dordo village of Kutch district in the state of Gujarat. Other festivals of Gujarat: Navratri, Uttarayan, Shamlaji Melo, Vautha Mela, Rath Yatra, Modhera Dance Festival, Bhadra Purnima, Bhavnath Mahadev Fair, etc.

Q74. Which Indian musician and sitar player is the founder of the National Orchestra of India?

- A) Ravi Shankar**
- B) Shahid Parvez Khan
- C) Kishan Maharaj
- D) Ayyagari Syamasundaram

Solution: 1.(a) Ravi Shankar. He was an Indian musician and player of the sitar, who was influential in stimulating Western appreciation of Indian music. His Awards: Bharat Ratna (1999), Padma Vibhushan (1981), Padma Bhushan (1967) and Grammy Award (1968) for Best Chamber Music Performance for his work "West Meets East".

Q75. Match the following Sportsman in List I and Award in List II :

- A) A-ii, B-i, C-iv, D-iii
- B) A-iii, B-iv, C-i, D-ii
- C) A-i, B-iii, C-ii, D-iv**
- D) A-iv, B-i, C-iii, D-ii

Solution: 6.(a) A-ii, B-i, C-iv, D-iii. Devendra Jhajharia (Paralympic javelin thrower) : Awards - Major Dhyan Chand Khel Ratna (2017), Padma Shri (2012), Arjuna Award (2004). Sumit Antil (javelin thrower) : Award - Khel Ratna Award (2021). Neeraj Chopra : Awards - Arjuna Award (2018), Padma Shri (2022). Shikhar Dhawan is an Indian former cricketer.